

Chapter 80-1

Zhao Xuning's words made Liang Shi momentarily stunned.

A moment later, Liang Shi took out her keys to open the door. She smiled casually, "I'm really liking you more and more."

Zhao Xuning: "?"

"Don't." Zhao Xuning said, "I have no interest in you."

Liang Shi glanced at her: "What are you thinking? I mean the kind of liking where I admire you."

Zhao Xuning: "...It's still best if you don't."

The security here was particularly good—the building entrance required facial recognition or fingerprint, and the apartment door used a key plus facial or fingerprint recognition. This double security system put Liang Shi completely at ease.

After the facial recognition, Liang Shi pushed open the door and found that the place was cleaner and brighter than before. The smell inside was also much better, without the dusty scent of a long-unoccupied space that she had noticed during her previous visit.

Zhao Xuning must have had someone clean it.

Liang Shi brought in her and Xu Qingzhu's suitcases while teasing Zhao Xuning, "Dr. Zhao, you're really too thoughtful."

"No." Zhao Xuning had her hands stuffed in her coat pockets, her expression cold. She reached up to adjust her glasses, looking every bit like an aloof beauty.¹ "I'm the landlord, and you need to pay me rent, so having someone clean the apartment is perfectly normal. There's no need to develop feelings for me because of this."

Liang Shi: "..."

She looked at Zhao Xuning: "Dr. Zhao, do you have some kind of psychological trauma about making friends?"

Zhao Xuning pressed her lips together and lifted her chin toward the living room. "Hurry up and get things sorted. There's still things to do."

Before tidying up, Liang Shi first made a phone call to Zhou Li, saying she had some matters to attend to today and would come in the afternoon to do the handover work. The higher-ups had already approved her resignation.

Zhou Li then asked if she had time tonight.

After thinking about it, Liang Shi replied, "Yes, I do."

"Everyone wants to throw you a farewell party, treat you to dinner and karaoke." Zhou Li said.

Liang Shi chuckled softly, "Alright."

After hanging up, Zhao Xuning said in a flat tone, "You're quite popular at the company."

Liang Shi raised an eyebrow: "Of course. Aren't you?"

Zhao Xuning: "...Working at a hospital, professional competence is more important than popularity."

Liang Shi: "..."

Was it that hard to tell the truth?

But then again, Liang Shi felt she couldn't understand the world of geniuses.

Just like how Xu Qingzhu even had to compete with her when it came to waking up.

She simply couldn't understand any of it.

Liang Shi felt that among all these highly ambitious and driven people, she seemed like a salted fish² in comparison.

But clearly! She used to work very hard too!

What puzzled Liang Shi even more was that in the ABO worldview setting, Alphas generally had greater physical strength and intelligence than Omegas, and Omegas were stronger than Betas.

Of course, this was also a matter of probability.

What was rarest of all was that Xu Qingzhu, as an Omega, was both so beautiful and had such high intelligence.

Perhaps her only shortcoming was physical stamina.

Liang Shi secretly thought it was a pity.

However, she only briefly pondered this question.

After all, this world was created by an author, with countless personal settings and possible logical bugs. As long as things could be wrapped up to let it end, and the Alpha female lead and the Omega female lead could be together, that was enough.

A romance-driven novel—wasn't it just about being lovey-dovey and romantic?

What more could you ask for?³

Liang Shi even momentarily felt that she was here to fix the author's logical bugs, considering the crazy character content here was seriously off the charts.

But as the novel's female lead, Xu Qingzhu was indeed perfect with no flaws.

"What are you thinking about?" Zhao Xuning waved her hand in front of Liang Shi's face. "Is the view outside that captivating?"

"It's actually not bad." Liang Shi came back to her senses and only then realized she had been staring out at the river view, lost in thought. "Dr. Zhao, is your university near here?"

Zhao Xuning nodded: "Yes."

"Is there any good food at your university?" Liang Shi said, "Can you recommend some to me?"

Zhao Xuning: "..."

Although Zhao Xuning tried to keep her tone as flat as possible, Liang Shi could still detect the disdain in that casual tone: "Is that a question a female celebrity should be asking?"

Liang Shi: "...I'm not one yet."

"Aren't you joining the production crew next week?" Zhao Xuning said, "My cousin never eats fried or puffed snacks in the week before filming starts, and she doesn't eat anything after 5 PM. Among all the food near the university district, there's nothing a female celebrity can eat."

Liang Shi: "..."

"I'm getting it for Xu Qingzhu to eat." Liang Shi said, "Don't you think she's too thin?"

Zhao Xuning: "..."

After two seconds of silence, Zhao Xuning said: "I don't think so."

Liang Shi was speechless. She suddenly understood why Dr. Zhao had no friends.

Dr. Zhao's EQ⁴ must have been sacrificed to subsidize her IQ. But then again, Liang Shi actually thought she was quite genuine this way.

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1. "Aloof beauty" (高嶺之花, gāolǐng zhī huā) — literally "flower on a high peak," a Chinese/Japanese expression referring to someone beautiful but unapproachable, like a flower growing on a mountain peak that's too high to reach. ⇐
 2. "Salted fish" (鹹魚, xiányú) — Chinese internet slang for someone who has no ambition or motivation and just wants to lie around doing nothing, like a dead fish that's been salted for preservation. ⇐
 3. "What more could you ask for?" — The original phrase is "還要什麼自行車?" (literally "what more, a bicycle?"), a Chinese internet slang expression meaning "what more do you want?" or "don't be greedy." It comes from a comedy sketch and implies someone should be satisfied with what they have. ⇐
 4. "EQ" — Emotional Quotient, referring to emotional intelligence. ⇐

Chapter 80-2

After their conversation fell apart, Zhao Xuning sent Liang Shi a Word document.

Liang Shi: "What's this?"

Before Zhao Xuning could answer, she clicked on it and discovered it was a food guide for the area near Haizhou City Medical University.

From this guide, one could see the rigor of a science student—snacks of the same type were grouped together for comparison, then rated through a scoring system. The top three most delicious places were highlighted with different colored backgrounds.

"So impressive." Liang Shi exclaimed.

Zhao Xuning put away her phone. "It's from a few years ago. The taste might not be the same now, and those shops might not even exist anymore. You'll have to do field research yourself."

Liang Shi: "..."

"Did you make this?" Liang Shi suddenly asked.

Zhao Xuning nodded: "Of course."

"Did you make it for that girlfriend of yours?" Liang Shi asked.

Zhao Xuning glanced at her but didn't answer directly. Instead, she urged, "Go tidy up."

After saying this, she crossed her legs and sat on the sofa, her pose frozen in place, looking very much like she was shooting for a magazine.

Anyone who didn't know better would think she was a model with a camera set up not far away.

Liang Shi had always felt there was a kind of affectation about Zhao Xuning, but it wasn't the kind that made people dislike her.

Liang Shi looked at her back and shook her head helplessly. She put her own things in the second bedroom and placed Xu Qingzhu's suitcase in the master bedroom.

Liang Shi noticed that a girlish pink cushion had been added to the bay window in the master bedroom, making the whole room feel more feminine.

But it seemed like it was still missing a few decorative plushies, as well as a bookshelf that could be placed in the corner.

Xu Qingzhu liked reading, but there was no study here. They could put a bookshelf in the corner though. Also, the bed here didn't have a nightstand. Liang Shi planned to buy a smart nightstand.

One side could have temperature-controlled heated water, and the other side could have smart charging.

She silently planned in her mind what else she could add to Xu Qingzhu's room and roughly had a framework.

As for her own room, when she was putting away clothes, she glanced at the wardrobe and figured she just needed to buy some mothballs to put inside so the clothes wouldn't get damp.

Both of their rooms needed vanity tables. Buying two at the same time should be cheaper.

There were also no kitchen utensils. In the end, Liang Shi didn't trust her own memory, so she recorded everything in her phone's notes app.

While going downstairs, she said to Zhao Xuning, "After the photoshoot, come with me to the mall."

Zhao Xuning silently watched her make notes and suddenly felt that her own life was really rough.

...

That apartment was at a level where she could just move in and live there directly.

It seemed like ever since she broke up with Shen Hui, her life had become increasingly rough. Before, she would occasionally put on makeup—eyeshadow, eyeliner, mascara, blush—nothing was skipped.

But now... putting on lipstick was already the most makeup she would do.

In the past, Shen Hui liked to do these things together with her, putting makeup on each other.

Shen Hui's favorite thing was to apply lipstick on her, and then bite her lips.

Zhao Xuning would always laugh at her, "You're eating a stomachful of chemicals."

Shen Hui would sit in her lap, lean down to kiss her, acting coquettish in a teasing way, "I'll bite the inside."

Often before she could even finish speaking, she would already be swallowed up by a kiss.

Later, Zhao Xuning was afraid she would really eat a stomachful of chemicals, so she even researched and made lipsticks herself, all using plants.

But most of the time, Zhao Xuning didn't really wear any.

So Shen Hui liked to press her own lipstick onto her lips, then use her fingers to spread it out.

...

Liang Shi patted her, "Dr. Zhao, what are you thinking about?"

Zhao Xuning came back to her senses, "Nothing."

The reason she didn't think Xu Qingzhu was overly thin was because there was someone even thinner than Xu Qingzhu.

Having seen what Shen Hui looked like after becoming so thin that she lost all her baby fat, Xu Qingzhu's thinness was nothing in comparison.

Because she looked so thin, every time she saw her, she felt heartache.

Yet she couldn't help but think of her every few days.

If it weren't for Liang Shi needing an apartment, she would never have set foot in this residential complex.

This place held all the most beautiful memories between her and Shen Hui. After coming here, she couldn't help but reminisce.

Chapter 80-3

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Zhao Xuning's younger cousin attended Qingyi University, the best university in Haizhou City and also a top-tier university nationwide.

It was similar to Peking University or Tsinghua University in Liang Shi's original world.¹

Xu Qingzhu had also graduated from this school.

Liang Shi had come here to eat with Xu Qingzhu last time. That devilishly spicy food was still fresh in her memory—it made her drink several glasses of water when she got home that night.

The area near the university district was full of students, with many people coming and going.

Zhao Xuning parked her car quite far from the school gate because there were no parking spots any closer.

The two walked to the school entrance, where Zhao Xuning's younger cousin was already waiting.

When he saw Liang Shi, he froze for a few seconds, then looked at Zhao Xuning: "This is the model you found for me?"

Zhao Xuning glanced at him and said coldly: "Not satisfied?"

"No, that's not it." Zhao Xuning's cousin was stunned for a moment, scratched the back of his head, and then said with confusion: "I just feel like I've seen this older sister somewhere before."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

She slapped him on the head. "She's married. What kind of thing is that to say?"

The cousin felt wronged and rubbed the spot where he was hit, explaining: "I'm not hitting on her, it's just... I really feel like I've seen her before."

Liang Shi chuckled softly from the side and gave him a timely reminder: "The concert hall."

His eyes lit up. "I remember now! You're the older sister who sat next to me at the concert last time. You were with another super super super pretty older sister, and later we exchanged a few words outside the concert hall because of buying tanghulu,² right?"

Liang Shi: "...Yes."

She actually really wanted to ask why Xu Qingzhu was "super super super pretty," while she wasn't even memorable enough to leave an impression?

Zhao Xuning's cousin was already greeting her in a very familiar manner. "Older sister, my name is Zhao Ling. I'm a sophomore in the Photography Department. What a coincidence! I never expected you to be my cousin's friend."

"I also know your older sister." Liang Shi said, "Your sister helped me before."

"Huh?" Zhao Ling was surprised and immediately said, "That's coincidence upon coincidence."

Liang Shi and Zhao Xuning didn't talk much when they were together; neither of them were eloquent people.

But Zhao Ling was different—he talked a lot and was very sociable.

Just in the time it took to walk from the school gate to the sports field, Liang Shi had already learned which cafeteria and which window at their school had the best food.

Zhao Ling needed to shoot three sets of photos in total. It wasn't as exaggerated as Zhao Xuning had described earlier, but it was still... not to be underestimated.

One set was a JK plaid skirt³ with white stockings to the knee, paired with black leather shoes, and twin tails.

Liang Shi: "..."

One set was a red floor-length dress with a high slit, more like something that would appear at an awards ceremony.

This was actually a style Liang Shi wore more often.

But this kind of bright red—unless you were someone extremely confident in your figure and looks, you definitely wouldn't wear it.

After all, if worn poorly, it could easily look gaudy and tacky.

There was also a set with a white baseball uniform, a very short skirt, and a cap to match.

...

Sure enough, three sets of photos, three completely different styles.

In one morning, Liang Shi had to play three roles: a cute 2D girl,⁴ an aloof female celebrity, and a sporty student.

After hearing Zhao Ling's introduction, Liang Shi finally understood why Zhao Xuning had been unwilling.

But Liang Shi was puzzled about one thing: "These just need someone with good body proportions to shoot. Why did it have to be someone over 170cm? Tall people wearing JK look quite strange."

Zhao Ling thought for a moment and said with great certainty: "That's exactly the contrast effect we want."

Liang Shi: "..."

Alright then.

She went to change into the most casual outfit first—the baseball uniform. The students' conditions were simple, so she could only change clothes in a bathroom stall.

One of Zhao Ling's junior female classmates took her there.

It was only after arriving that she learned this was actually a group assignment, and Zhao Ling had taken on finding the model and doing the photography himself, while a group of junior classmates followed him to help out.

Liang Shi's body proportions were excellent. Wearing this casual baseball uniform made her legs look very long, slender, and fair.

Wearing a baseball uniform in this weather was still a bit cold, so they gave her flesh-colored leggings to wear underneath.

Even so, it was still very cold.

When Liang Shi came, she was worried their makeup products would be too low-quality, so she brought her own makeup. Before the shoot, she quickly redid her makeup.

When it came to this kind of thing, she was absolutely professional.

After changing and coming out, she shivered from the cold, then enjoyed the gazes of Zhao Ling's small team.

A group of younger girls exclaimed, "Older sister is so pretty."

They really knew how to talk, surrounding Liang Shi and chirping compliments—over a dozen compliments without repeating a single one.

It was Zhao Ling who called out, "Everyone get to your positions. We're going to start shooting."

Then those responsible for lighting went to handle the lighting, those responsible for assisting went to assist, and they all dispersed in an instant.

Liang Shi stood there, completely at Zhao Ling's direction.

Zhao Ling's photography experience wasn't very extensive, so finding angles was something Liang Shi had to do herself.

Fortunately, as someone who had experienced countless magazine shoots, Liang Shi could easily find the right angles and then let Zhao Ling take the photos.

When you're beautiful, any casual shot becomes a stunning photo.

Even so, Zhao Ling was still striving for perfection.

Liang Shi was so cold that even her nose had turned red. As soon as they finished, one of the junior girls immediately draped a coat over her—quite the treatment of a big star.

At times like this, Liang Shi felt she had been quite foresighted, having worn a thick long trench coat when she came out.

Only after putting on her own coat did she finally feel some warmth.

But soon she had to go change into the next outfit—the JK set.

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1. Peking University and Tsinghua University — The two most prestigious universities in China, often considered the Chinese equivalent of Ivy League schools. ↵
 2. Tanghulu (糖葫蘆) — A traditional Chinese snack consisting of candied hawthorn berries (or other fruits) on a stick, coated in a hardened sugar syrup. ↵
 3. JK — Short for "joshi kōsei" (女子高生), meaning "high school girl" in Japanese. JK fashion refers to Japanese high school uniform-style clothing, particularly the pleated plaid skirts, which has become a popular fashion subculture. ↵
 4. 2D girl (二次元萌妹) — Refers to the cute, anime-style aesthetic associated with Japanese animation and manga culture. "2D" literally refers to two-dimensional animated characters, and the style emphasizes youthful, cute appearances. ↵

Chapter 80-4

Although Liang Shi was tall, her body proportions were good, so wearing JK at 172cm didn't look out of place.

She spent half an hour removing her makeup and redoing it—a very light look that completely changed her entire aura. Her brown hair hung down on both sides, tied into twin tails, giving her a very youthful, girlish vibe.

When she came out, Zhao Xuning was drinking a cup of hot milk tea that someone had bought for her. Upon seeing Liang Shi, she sprayed out a mouthful of milk tea.

Liang Shi: "..."

Seriously.

She had already used her masterful makeup skills to salvage her image, okay?

She walked over and shot Zhao Xuning a glare. "What are you laughing at?"

Zhao Xuning coughed softly and turned her face away. "Sorry, I couldn't help it."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi said through gritted teeth, "Don't forget, you're the one who found this job for me."

Zhao Xuning nodded, already unable to suppress her smile. That iceberg face of hers was on the verge of cracking. "Your style change is too drastic."

Liang Shi scoffed lightly. "Being an actress naturally involves many different styles."

Because you're playing someone else, not yourself.

If you want to make breakthroughs, you must constantly challenge different styles.

Once you become complacent, it means the end of your career is in sight.

She couldn't explain all these intricacies to Zhao Xuning, but after hearing what she said, Zhao Xuning understood.

However, during the photoshoot, Zhao Xuning couldn't resist taking out her phone to snap a few pictures, sending them all to Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu was in her office signing documents. When she heard the message notification, she picked up her water glass while checking the message.

As soon as the water went into her mouth, Liang Shi wearing JK appeared on the screen.

If it weren't for that face being so familiar, she almost wouldn't have recognized her.

Xu Qingzhu wasn't as mischievous as Zhao Xuning—she forcibly held back and didn't spray out her water, but it made her cough several times, nearly unable to recover.

She poked at her screen and sent Zhao Xuning six dots.

Zhao Xuning: [How is it?]

Xu Qingzhu: [...The style has changed.]

Zhao Xuning: [I think so too.]

Xu Qingzhu: [But it looks quite good. She can try this in the future.]

Zhao Xuning: [...Is there something wrong with your eyes?]

Xu Qingzhu looked at that question, and a few seconds later replied: [Is there something wrong with your eyes?]

This time it was Zhao Xuning's turn to send her six dots.

Meanwhile, Xu Qingzhu quietly saved those pictures, then asked Zhao Xuning: [Is there a high-definition version? Can you get the original photos from your cousin's shoot?]

Zhao Xuning: [...Shouldn't you get the person's consent first?]

Xu Qingzhu: [Then take a few more photos and send them to me. Are there any others?]

Zhao Xuning: [...You should come see for yourself.]

Xu Qingzhu: [Sigh.jpg]

—[Missed it.]

Zhao Xuning was a real friend and took many photos for her. She then said that when the final photos were ready, she would mail a photo album to her home.

Mailed to her home, with Liang Shi's name, Xu Qingzhu's phone number, placed in the delivery locker downstairs of their building.

Xu Qingzhu: [...Okay, thank you, Dr. Zhao.]

Zhao Xuning stared at the screen for a while, then looked at Liang Shi who was over there diligently modeling.

Why did she feel like she could smell the sour stench of love?¹

1. "Sour stench of love" (戀愛的酸臭味) — A humorous Chinese internet slang expression used to describe the overly sweet or obvious displays of affection between couples, often used by single people to tease couples or express mock disgust at their lovey-dovey behavior. ↩

Chapter 80-5

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The last outfit was the red slit dress—the most difficult one to pull off, and also the coldest one.

Liang Shi spent another half hour removing her makeup, reapplying makeup, and doing her hair. Originally, Zhao Ling had found friends to do the makeup and hair, but Liang Shi thought they were too slow, and no one understood her own face better than she did.

So she chose to do it herself.

At first, Zhao Ling was a bit skeptical of her skills, but when Liang Shi came out after finishing, Zhao Ling felt that hiring a makeup artist was a mistake!

That money should have just gone directly to Liang Shi.

When Liang Shi came out of the bathroom wearing that gown, she immediately drew the attention of everyone around.

When she had changed into the previous outfits, people had looked too, but it was nothing like now—everyone's gazes turned toward her, and they let out gasps of amazement in unison.

Liang Shi had also dusted a light layer of shimmer powder on her collarbones and put on her own silver diamond-shaped long earrings.

She was already tall, and now wearing high heels, she looked even more tall and striking.

Standing in the crowd, she was an existence that would be noticed at first glance.

The junior girl who had brought her to change clothes had starry eyes and kept exclaiming, "Oh my god, what kind of fairy is this? She's way too beautiful."

"Wuwuwu, if you weren't married, older sister, I'd want to pursue you."

"But I feel like I probably wouldn't be worthy of you, wuwuwu."

Liang Shi smiled and said, "Stop teasing me. Let's go."

"This isn't teasing, it's the truth!" The junior girl said, "Older sister, are you really not considering entering the entertainment industry? I now feel that the entertainment industry not having you is a loss for all the fans' eyes."

Liang Shi was embarrassed by the praise and said in a low voice, "I'm in talks about it."

It was an official, non-committal answer.

In this regard, Liang Shi had long since mastered the art of giving official responses.

The junior girl hugged her own arms tightly, her face eager: "You definitely have to enter! Wuwuwu, when that happens, I'll be your number one fan leader."

Liang Shi smiled and said, "Focus on your studies first."

After she walked out of the bathroom, she hadn't taken more than a few steps when almost everyone simultaneously turned their gazes from all directions to look at Liang Shi.

Then they all uniformly drew in a sharp breath. Shortly after, like hot water falling into a pot of boiling oil, various voices kept ringing out.

"What major is she from?"

"Holy crap, she's way too good-looking."

"Is she an A or an O? Damn, I really want to pursue her."

"So domineering, *inhales*."¹

"That collarbone, that waist, that back... damn, is this something I can see for free?"

"..."

All kinds of comments echoed from every corner of the sports field.

Meanwhile, Zhao Ling, who was waiting over there chatting with his junior classmates, suddenly had someone tug at his sleeve. "Quick, look."

Zhao Ling asked casually, "Is Sister Liang ready?"

As he spoke, he turned around, and then froze in shock.

This was originally an outfit that could very easily be worn in an extremely tacky way—the slightest carelessness would expose all one's physical flaws. Yet Liang Shi wore it with exceptional elegance.

Combined with her makeup and hair, it was nothing short of perfect.

It was the level where she could outshine all the female celebrities even at a film awards ceremony.

Zhao Ling stared in amazement, then quietly sidled up to Zhao Xuning and asked, "Does my older sister know she's about to have a competitor like this?"

Zhao Xuning glanced at him sideways. "Your sister personally promoted her."

Zhao Ling: "..."

Two seconds later, he commented, "Zhao Ying really can't think things through."

Zhao Xuning didn't say anything. She just found a decent angle, took a photo, and sent it to Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu: [...Just how many more surprises does this person have that we don't know about.]

Zhao Xuning: [Probably many.]

While they were chatting on this side, on the other side of the sports field, two other people also looked over, following the crowd's comments and gazes.

Shen Siyan only saw that flamboyant red dress and couldn't help but frown: "Isn't she cold?"

Shen Hui smiled, hands stuffed in the pockets of her brown trench coat. "Beautiful women aren't afraid of the cold."

Shen Siyan frowned as he watched, then took off his own scarf and wrapped it around Shen Hui. "Second Sister, let's not copy her. I feel cold just looking at her."

Shen Hui smiled helplessly. "You're so silly. Have you gotten a girlfriend yet?"

Hearing this question, Shen Siyan's frown deepened. "Isn't studying the most important thing for me right now? That way I can hurry and join the company to share Eldest Sister's burden. Otherwise, it'll be hard to put Eldest Sister and Sister Gu's wedding date on the agenda."

"You really think too much." Shen Hui looked at him with concern. "As a student, the most important thing is to have fun while making sure you don't fail your classes, enjoying your youth and university life. Don't be so old-fashioned that you don't have any fun at all."

"Sigh..." Shen Siyan let her words go in one ear and out the other. While looking around, he spotted a familiar figure.

After he let out that sigh, Shen Hui asked him, "What's wrong?"

Shen Siyan immediately blocked her view, his tone stiff. "Nothing. Just some scum. Don't pay attention to them."

"I saw." Shen Hui pushed him aside. "I saw a long time ago."

Shen Siyan sighed. "Second Sister, can't we just let ourselves move on? Romance has no future."

Shen Hui glanced at him sideways. "But I'm not in a relationship."

"Getting entangled with a scumbag ex is also without a future." Shen Siyan said, "The one Dad introduced to you isn't bad. High IQ, high EQ, good family background, and most importantly, good character. Are you really not going to consider it?"

Although Shen Siyan was the youngest sibling in the family, he spoke with a mature tone and thought about many things.

It was probably because everyone above him in the family were older sisters. This younger brother had set his goal from a young age: to protect his sisters.

And so he grew up to be this precocious.

Other people's high school: studying, puppy love, skipping class.

Shen Siyan's high school: catching his sisters dating, beating up people who tried to hit on his sisters.

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1. "So domineering, *inhales*" (好禦啊, 斯哈) — Internet slang expressing attraction. "禦" (yù) refers to a "御姐" (yùjiě) type, meaning a mature, powerful, commanding woman. "斯哈" is an onomatopoeia representing the sound of sharply inhaling through one's teeth, expressing that something is so attractive it takes your breath away. ⇐

Chapter 80-6

Shen Hui looked toward Zhao Xuning in the distance. She was wearing a black trench coat, still in a very simple and plain outfit. Her long hair was casually tied up, loosely bound, with stray hairs on both sides of her face. It would probably fall out after just a few steps.

This person was always like this—when tying her hair, she was always afraid of damaging it, so she only wrapped the hair tie around twice.

Zhao Xuning was holding her phone, leaning lightly against the school railing, which came up just to her waist.

Wearing gold wire-rimmed glasses, her whole demeanor appeared very proper and old-fashioned, yet her posture was casual and languid.

Restrained and refined, yet with a touch of nonchalance—it was rare for someone to perfectly blend these two temperaments together.

Yet Zhao Xuning was an outstanding example of exactly that.

She seemed not to care about anyone, those narrow, fox-like eyes hidden beneath her glasses.

Time seemed to suddenly rewind to many years ago. Back then at school, Zhao Xuning had been in this same state.

Despite being a junior, she was arrogant beyond measure.

Back then, she also liked to stand at the sports field, leaning lightly against the railing, casually and languidly watching people in the distance.

Later, after they got together, Shen Hui had asked her what she was looking at.

Zhao Xuning had answered, "Looking at my girlfriend."

Because back then, Shen Hui liked to run on the sports field. She would run in the morning and in the evening. When she ran, she would always see Zhao Xuning and couldn't help but be drawn to her.

As long as she stood there, Shen Hui's eyes would be on her.

And the direction she was looking at was indeed Shen Hui.

In the morning sun, in the sunset, in the thin mist, in the sky full of red clouds.

There had always been Shen Hui in Zhao Xuning's eyes.

"Second Sister!" Shen Siyan called out to her unhappily. "If you keep looking, you two are going to rekindle your old flame."

Shen Hui chuckled softly. "What are you worried about?"

"Of course I'm worried about you." Shen Siyan assumed an elder's attitude. "Have you forgotten how she treated you back then? We can set aside how she treated you, but character issues, especially things involving bottom lines in a relationship, there's absolutely no room for negotiation, okay? I think you should go on more blind dates, meet more good Alphas, and then you won't be blinded by this person. She was deceiving you all along."

"Oh my." Shen Hui pinched his face. "How come my little brother talks like he knows everything? You've never even been in a relationship and you want to teach your sister about dating? Don't you know that without experience, you have no right to speak?"

Shen Siyan: "..."

This scene was particularly glaring in Zhao Xuning's eyes.

After she finished taking photos of Liang Shi and sending them to Xu Qingzhu, she noticed Shen Hui standing over there. There was also a boy standing next to Shen Hui, wearing a blue jacket and jeans.

It seemed so.

He looked very young. There were some very intimate gestures between Shen Hui and him—their relationship must be unusual.

Was that Shen Hui's new boyfriend?

Zhao Xuning gripped her phone tightly, her fingers turning white, the veins on the back of her hand clearly visible.

She really wanted to go over and say hello, but she was afraid of hearing something unpleasant.

For example, that he really was Shen Hui's current partner.

Zhao Xuning closed her eyes briefly, took a deep breath, and just then Zhao Ling finished up on his end. Liang Shi went to change clothes accompanied by the junior girls.

Zhao Ling looked at the photos in the camera and couldn't help but sigh. "Sister Liang is really suited to be a model. She can pull off any style. This shoot went so smoothly. Cousin, you're really good at finding people. I'll treat you both to lunch."

Even after he finished speaking, Zhao Xuning showed no reaction. Only when he looked up did he notice that Zhao Xuning was staring straight at the other side of the sports field.

Following her gaze, Zhao Ling immediately frowned. "Oh man, enemies really do cross paths on narrow roads."¹

Zhao Xuning came back to her senses. "You know him?"

Even her voice had become strained.

Zhao Ling nodded. "Cousin, you don't know him? Wasn't it because of him that you lectured me last time?"

Zhao Xuning was surprised. "When?"

"That phone call." Zhao Ling said, "You told me not to cause trouble at school and not to bully people. It was him—the tattletale. Isn't that your ex-girlfriend, the one you treasured at the tip of your heart, standing right next to him? You've never seen him before?"

Zhao Xuning: "..."

Her tone even rose a pitch: "So, he's Shen Siyan?"

Zhao Ling nodded.

Meanwhile, Liang Shi, who had returned after changing clothes, was standing behind them and asked in confusion: "Shen Siyan is a guy?"

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1. "Enemies really do cross paths on narrow roads" (冤家路窄) — A Chinese idiom meaning that enemies or people with grievances tend to run into each other unexpectedly, especially in inconvenient situations. ↩